

book has taught you anything, it's that the jargon in the investing world isn't nearly as scary as it seems.)

Positive screening

Positive screening is the simple act of choosing what causes matter to you and investing in companies that meet those criteria, such as:

- carbon neutrality
- Certified B Corps (companies that meet strict regulations and hold the highest standards for social and environmental performance)
- board or management diversity
- vegan friendliness
- support for nonprofits (e.g. a glasses company that has a 'buy one pair, we donate one pair' policy).

Any company or fund portfolio will show you whether they support causes important to you.

Negative screening

In 2016, many New Zealand retirement account holders learned that they were invested in companies making landmines and nuclear weapons. This of course outraged the general public and, as a result, most KiwiSaver funds now exclude warfare-related products from their portfolios. Making sure you don't invest in companies that don't align with certain ethical values is called negative screening.

Negative screening is a lot easier to measure as an investor in training. We tend to be clearer about what we don't like than what we do like (I usually know what I don't want to eat over what I do). It's the idea of getting rid of investments in companies that engage with certain products or practices that you disagree with such as:

- gambling
- animal testing